BLOCK Report

ONE-PAGE BRIEF · HACKATHON PROTOTYPE

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One complaint gets ignored.
Two hundred become evidence.

A one-day civic build: residents report neighborhood problems by web or plain text message, AI turns scattered complaints into a pattern, and community organizers get a one-click evidence packet for City Council.

THE PROBLEM

Newark residents reported missed garbage pickups for weeks and were told to wait. Rats moved in. People were complaining, but nothing changed.

THE REAL MECHANISM

Every complaint arrives alone. Forty separate calls look like forty small problems, not one big failure. **Nobody can see the pattern.**

WHO IT'S FOR

Block, neighborhood and tenant associations who speak at Council, and any resident who wants their report to count. No app, no account.

HOW IT WORKS

01 Report

Web form or plain SMS, in English, Spanish or Portuguese. Name never shown.

02 Sort

AI suggests category and issue; the resident confirms. Missing info? One question back.

03 Cluster

Reports on the same block group on a map. Big or long-running clusters turn urgent.

04 Packet

One click: a one-page council summary with real counts and quotes, no names.

WHERE AI FITS, AND WHY

1. Sorting. Messy, multilingual texts become clean reports from a fixed list of 5 categories, returned as structured data.

2. The council packet. Dozens of reports become one calm, factual page. Rule: use only facts in the reports; never invent a number, date or quote.

The test it passes: a chatbot helps one person write one complaint. It can't combine 200 neighbors into evidence.

PRODUCT DECISIONS I MADE

Never promise what you can't deliver. First AI replies said "we'll follow up." We weren't. Confirmations now come from a fixed template: your report counts.

Count neighbors, not reports. Repeat posts become "still happening" updates, so one person can't look like five.

AI suggests, people decide. Residents confirm categories; organizers choose what goes into every packet.

Updates come from neighbors. The organizer who presents at Council triggers the update text, not the city.

2	3	5	1 day
AI steps	languages	issue categories	problem to prototype

WHAT'S NEXT

Launch SMS reporting for residents without smartphones · add languages · pilot with community groups the city already works with, such as Love Your Block grantees · optional phone verification and organizer review for suspicious bursts.

Hackathon prototype with fictional sample data. No real users or impact claimed.

prachigpt113-gif.github.io/Portfolio/blockreport/